



# GOVERNANCE

## E-Governance

**MODULE - 3**



## INTRODUCTION

- 1 According to the World Bank, 'E-Governance refers to the use by government agencies of information technologies (viz., wide area networks, the Internet, and mobile computing) that have the ability to transform relations with citizens, businesses and other arms of government.
- 2 These technologies can serve a variety of different ends: better delivery of government services to citizens, improved interactions with business and industry, citizen empowerment through access to information or more efficient government management.
- 3 The resulting benefits can be less corruption, increased transparency, greater convenience, revenue growth and/or cost reductions.



## TYPES OF INTERACTIONS IN E-GOVERNANCE

**1** As per the second administrative reforms committee's report, e-Governance facilitates interaction between different stakeholders in governance.

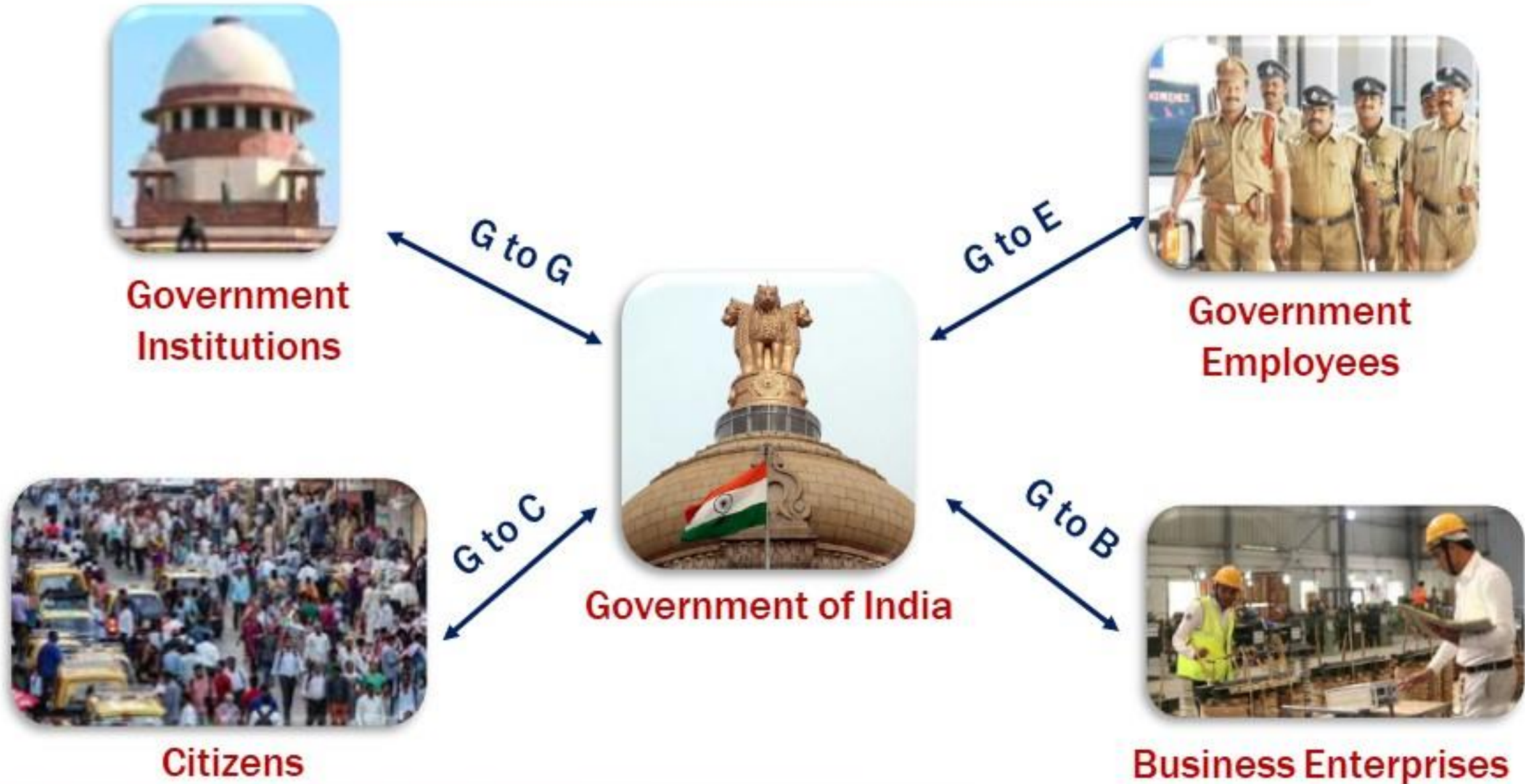
**2** It states that there are four types of interactions in e-Governance as follows:

- Government to Citizens (G2C)
- Government to Business (G2B)
- Government to Government (G2G)
- Government to Employees (G2E)





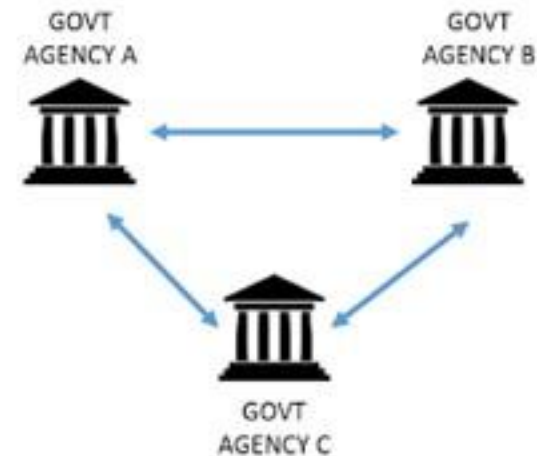
# TYPES OF INTERACTIONS IN E-GOVERNANCE



## TYPES OF INTERACTIONS IN E-GOVERNANCE

### G2G (GOVERNMENT TO GOVERNMENT)

- 1 With this mode of interaction, besides restructuring the governmental processes involved, information technology and communication (IT&C) helps in improving the flow of information and services within and between the different stakeholders involved, such as, departments within and across ministries.
- 2 The interaction can happen in both horizontal and vertical directions.
- 3 The key objective and outcome of e-Governance in this relationship is the need to increase efficiency, performance and productivity.





## TYPES OF INTERACTIONS IN E-GOVERNANCE

### G2C (GOVERNMENT TO CITIZENS)

- 1** The purpose of any initiative that would improve governance will result in better delivery of services to citizens.
- 2** In this respect, e-Governance enables the creation of a digitalisation between the government and citizens.
- 3** This will enable the latter to benefit from efficient delivery of a wide range of public services.
- 4** In addition to expanding the availability and accessibility, e-Governance also improves the quality of services as well. It seeks to make the government citizen friendly.



## TYPES OF INTERACTIONS IN E-GOVERNANCE

### G2C (GOVERNMENT TO CITIZENS)

**5** Additionally, it also raises the credibility of government in the minds of people.

**6** Through e-Governance, citizens have several advantages as follows:

**a** They can access services round-the-clock over the Internet.

**b** They have a variety of access points, such as common service centres, e-kiosks or from their home/workplace.





# TYPES OF INTERACTIONS IN E-GOVERNANCE

## G2B (GOVERNMENT TO BUSINESS)

- 1** The Ease of Doing Business is a critical element in the healthy development of a country.
- 2** For this purpose, it becomes imperative that the government business interactions are maintained in a seamless manner.
- 3** Reduction of red tape, time consumption, operational costs, and the need for transparency are the most essential requirements to enable a competitive and congenial business environment.
- 4** Transactional interactions, such as licensing, permits, procurement and revenue collection etc., can be accelerated through the deployment of e-Governance initiatives.
- 5** Such measures are sure to aid businesses to perform better and expand their operations





## TYPES OF INTERACTIONS IN E-GOVERNANCE

### G2E (GOVERNMENT TO EMPLOYEES)

- 1 Every Government depends highly on its workforce. Thus, it is vitally important to interact with its employees on a regular basis. This interaction has to happen on a two-way basis.
- 2 On one hand, the Government send its circulars, notifications and memoranda to its employees across Departments, with the push of a button.

- 3 Similarly, by using IT&C tools, the Government can also get to know and address the needs and concerns of its employees, on a faster and efficient manner, thereby satisfying them, which will lead to a much better functioning of the Government machinery.





## E-GOVERNANCE BRINGS SMART GOVERNANCE

- The purpose of implementing e-Governance is to raise the level of performance and ensure the proper delivery of services to all who deserve them.
- This will be possible through five main characteristics of e-Governance SMART system

### S IMPLIES SIMPLE

- What was carried out through several forms and documents would now be reduced and simplified with the help of IT&C tools.
- Through e-Governance, citizens will feel more comfortable to approach the government authorities to avail their services.





## E-GOVERNANCE BRINGS SMART GOVERNANCE

### M IMPLIES MORAL

The entry of a novel system will instil a new system of ethical values in the administrative machinery. Through the implementation of technology, the scope for mismanagement or corruption could be greatly reduced.



### A IMPLIES ACCOUNTABLE

- By imparting a robust framework in the management of information and processes, the performance at both individual and departmental levels can be effectively monitored.
- This results in a sense of accountability among the functionaries concerned.





## E-GOVERNANCE BRINGS SMART GOVERNANCE

### R IMPLIES RESPONSIVE

The streamlining of service delivery makes the system more responsive.



### T IMPLIES TRANSPARENT

- Information that was until now confined to archives of the government department will now be available in the public domain through e-governance.
- This will ensure transparency and will practically lessen the threshold for corruption





## BENEFITS OF E-GOVERNANCE

- 1** Citizens will be able to **access information easily** and can receive a higher quality of service.
- 2** E-governance would bring in **timely and reliable information** on the different aspects of governance and administrative actions.
- 3** It helps in **reducing time, effort and money by automating processes and establishing online accessibility of public services**. By bringing in short turnaround times, the organization and its processes can be controlled and managed much more effectively.
- 4** It provides an **interface for the people to interact with the government**. Such measures that enable participation will reinforce the faith of the people in democracy





## BENEFITS OF E-GOVERNANCE

- 5 E-governance can provide effective solutions to end red tape, unwarranted delay, etc., by using modern tools, techniques and instruments of e-Governance.
- 6 E-governance assists in reaching out to the corners of the country, even to places where it is physically impossible to reach in person.
- 7 By following a 'citizen-first policy', e-Governance empowers them.





**ICT ENABLED  
CONNECTED  
GOVERNANCE  
CONTRIBUTES TO:**

## INTERNALLY

- Avoidance of duplication
- Reducing transaction costs
- Simplifying bureaucratic procedures
- Greater efficiency
- Greater coordination and communication
- Enhanced transparency
- Information sharing between agencies
- Security of information management

## EXTERNALLY

- Faster service delivery
- Greater efficacy
- Increased flexibility of service use
- Innovation in service delivery
- Greater citizen empowerment
- Citizen participation



## LIMITATIONS OF E-GOVERNANCE

- 1** At present, there is no institutional agency to oversee the speedy and effective implementation of the Scheme.
- 2** There is a lack of universal e-Governance architecture at the national level, which could cause problems in the universal implementation of certain central-sector schemes among two or more states at the same time.
- 3** Integration of sections of users and institutions becomes difficult, when there is no common model.
- 4** Adequate training to officials is a must, while introducing any new system in governance. A lack in this domain will result in an incomplete effort, thereby defeating the purpose of the process.





## LIMITATIONS OF E-GOVERNANCE

- 5 E-governance initiatives are not receiving a warm welcome from the employees of government organisations.
- 6 Most of the time, e-Governance initiatives are done with a process-centric mind set instead of a citizen centric approach.
- 7 In countries such as India, there is a limited penetration of electronic communication.
- 8 A sizable proportion of the population is yet to get access to computers or electronic gadgets in their villages and towns.
- 9 Mere setting up of service centres in these areas would help little towards making it a success.
- 10 Also the very knowledge base for accepting this new system of governance has not been prepared.





## LIMITATIONS OF E-GOVERNANCE

- 11 People know little about how electronic devices work and would certainly feel difficult to adapt to the new system.
- 12 The limited Internet connectivity at present means that a large section of the population will not be able to access public services.
- 13 Resources are scarce and unavailable at right time.





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